MODULE 2 · STAY SAFE

Emergency Response

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Most people freeze in an emergency, not because they don't care, but because they don't know what to do first. That's the whole point of this page: a few basics, learned once, that make you the calm person in the room instead of the panicked one.

1. The One Number to Remember: 112

- 112 is India's unified emergency number. One call connects you to police, fire, and ambulance, anywhere in the country.
- 112 works across India wherever a cellular network is available. Many phones can place emergency calls even without an active SIM, depending on the device and network .
- Many smartphones let you trigger Emergency SOS using the power button or side button, though the exact method varies by device and settings.
- Old numbers still work too: 100 (police), 101 (fire), 108 (ambulance), 1091 (women in distress), 1098 (Childline).

Save 112 in your phone right now, under a name you'd actually remember to search for in a panic, like "SOS".

2. The First Few Minutes

1. Check the scene before you rush in. If there's live traffic, fire, or an exposed electrical wire, you helping shouldn't turn into two people needing rescue instead of one.

2. Call 112, or get someone nearby to call while you stay with the person. Speak slowly, and give the clearest location details you can, a landmark works better than an address if you're unsure of the exact one.

3. Don't move someone with a suspected serious injury, especially to the head, neck, or spine, unless staying put is more dangerous than moving.

4. Stay until help arrives, or until you've clearly handed off responsibility to someone else who's staying.

3. CPR, in Brief

CPR (Cardiopulmonary Resuscitation) is what you do when someone is unconscious and not breathing normally, to keep blood moving to their brain until professional help arrives. This is a summary, not a substitute for real training.

- Check first: tap their shoulders and shout. If there's no response and breathing looks abnormal or absent, that's when CPR is needed.
- Call 112 immediately, or have someone else call while you start.
- If you haven't been trained, hands-only CPR is still valuable: push hard and fast in the centre of the chest, about two pushes per second, and don't stop until help arrives or the person responds.
- A few minutes of imperfect CPR from an untrained bystander saves far more lives than perfect CPR that never starts because someone was too unsure to begin.

Indian Red Cross Society, First Aid · *learn proper CPR and first aid through a real training session*

4. The Good Samaritan Law: You're Protected

A lot of people hesitate to help accident victims because they're afraid of police trouble or hospital bills. In India, the law has your back.

- Since 2016, India's Good Samaritan guidelines protect people acting in good faith while helping road accident victims.
- You cannot be forced to reveal your name or personal details, or to appear repeatedly at a police station or in court, just for helping.
- You are not responsible for paying the victim's medical bills, and hospitals are required to treat the person first, before any paperwork.
- The single biggest factor in surviving a serious accident is getting help within the first hour. Hesitating to help out of legal fear is, quite literally, the exact problem this law was written to fix.

5. Quick Reference for Common Emergencies

- Choking: encourage them to cough. If they can't breathe, cough, or speak, give firm back blows between the shoulder blades, followed by abdominal thrusts if you've been trained.
- Burns: cool the area under running water for several minutes. Never apply ice, toothpaste, or butter, they make it worse.
- Heavy bleeding: press down firmly on the wound with a clean cloth, and keep pressing, don't lift it to check.
- Snake bite: keep the person still and calm, keep the bitten limb below heart level if possible, and get to a hospital fast. Don't cut the wound or try to suck out venom, that's an outdated myth that causes more harm.
- Fainting: lay the person flat, raise their legs slightly, and loosen anything tight around their neck.

6. Save These Numbers

- 112 — All-in-one emergency (police, fire, ambulance)
- 108 — Ambulance
- 100 — Police
- 101 — Fire
- 1091 — Women in distress
- 1098 — Childline (for any child or teen in trouble)
- 1930 — Cyber crime helpline

A Few Myths, Busted

Myth	Fact
Helping an accident victim will get you dragged into police and court hassle.	The Good Samaritan Law specifically protects you from exactly this. You can help and walk away.
You need to be trained to do CPR, otherwise don't try.	Hands-only CPR from an untrained bystander, done immediately, saves far more lives than waiting for a trained person to arrive.
For a snake bite, you should cut the wound and suck out the venom.	This is an outdated, harmful myth. Keep the person still and get to a hospital, that's it.

Useful Links

Indian Red Cross Society, First Aid · *learn CPR and first aid properly, including local training sessions*

112 India (ERSS) · *how India's unified emergency number works*

Childline India · *call 1098, free 24-hour helpline for children and teens in distress*

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